

“Usually, training is not given to candidates, as the work processes of the companies are same. Also, candidates are expected to actually have the skills mentioned in their profile. Once a trainee gets along with the working style, he is ready for the next level,” says Chouhan.

### Career Path

At any level, Web designers should be able to work with close deadlines and under pressure. Needless to mention, the time span between promotions, as well as the remuneration, is highly variable and dependant on the calibre and the contribution of the person in company projects. The career path in Web design can be divided into three levels.

**Junior Level:** Here, one begins as a trainee, and assists the senior Web designer with all the minor front-end tasks such as drawing, designing logos, and learning scripting processes and workflow. One gets to know the work process of the company and gets hands-on experience with various software tools, scripting languages, and other aspects of Web design.

Once promoted as a Web designer, the work profile includes activities like preparing HTML pages, designing logos, drawing, creating PowerPoint presentations for showing prototypes to clients, generating graphics and animations, determining flow of content, designing user interfaces, etc.

A Web designer can get promoted to a senior designer in about one to three years. While at this level, he can earn as low as between Rs 5,000 to Rs 10,000 per month in a non-CMM IT company. In a CMM organisation, one can expect to start off somewhere between Rs 8,000 to Rs 15,000 per month.

**Senior Level:** Here, one prepares the architecture of the Web site. The senior Web designer plans the activities to be performed for designing the site in accordance with the requirements of the client. He is in charge of the layout of the page, selection and usage of Web tools, image usage, colour combinations, additional features to be included, planning the content flow, etc., in addition to testing, bug fixing, and validating the Web site. The person at the top-most position in this “senior” territory is responsible for project co-ordination.

Advancing to the next level takes from three to five years. Remuneration ranging from Rs 15,000 to Rs 35,000 per month can be expected by a senior Web designer in an organ-

### The Webby Awards

Here is a random list of five sites that won awards for best Web site design at the Webby Awards 2006 (also known as “The Oscars of the Internet”).

**www.leoburnett.ca**

The site, developed by ARC Worldwide Ad Agency, a Division of Leo Burnett, won the Webby Award 2006 for Best Visual Design—Aesthetic. The site has an innovative design where pencil replaces cursor on a white background for navigation between letters.

**www.stylewars.com**

Developed by Code and Theory, this site won the Award in the People's Voice category. The site is about the documentary shot by Tony Silver on hip-hop and community.

**earth.google.com**

Google's Earth homepage received the Award for Best Visual Design—Function. Google Earth enables one to view geographic information of places all over the world with satellite imagery, maps, terrain, and 3D buildings.

**www.bookofcool.com**

Designed by Ocelot Productions Ltd, the site won the Award under the People's Voice category for Best Navigation / Structure. Book of Cool is a showcase for three DVDs and a 320-page book for learning fun skills in the holidays.

**www.dreamstudiodesign.com**

The site, designed by DSD Animations, won the Award for the best use of animation and motion graphics. It is a showcase of DSD Animation's own profile: services offered, work done, etc.

isation with CMM standards. In a non-CMM or small to mid-sized undertaking, one can expect somewhere between Rs 10,000 and Rs 25,000. Moving further, one can start an independent undertaking.

**Top Level:** At this level are the project managers and the client relations executives. The design team and the other teams involved in the development of the site are managed and co-ordinated by the project manager. He takes care of the requirements of the design teams in general. Task schedules, deadlines, and progress reports are prepared and passed on to higher management. The job is similar to that of account executives, and thus requires good interpersonal skills.

Client interaction is taken care of. Issues between the client and design team in the context of the site are addressed. Regular checks on the progress help decide whether the site has a unique appeal in accordance with the corporate ethos of the client organisation.

The project manager is at the top position; this is more of a managerial function. He takes care of clients and brings in more business for the company. The average remuneration for project managers in an organisation with CMM standards ranges from Rs 35,000 to figures in lakhs.

### Parting Words

“As more and more companies shift part or all of their operations to the Web—such as advertising, purchasing, selling, and researching—the demand for Web designers climbs exponentially,” says Salil Desai, asst. vice president, Arena Multimedia, which provides multimedia education.

Ultimately, Web design requires a nice blend of creativity and technical expertise. This is the field for you if you think you have a feel for the Web, and are willing to learn what drives it. ■

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### The Technical Armoury Of A Web Designer

- ☑ Adobe Creative Suite—Photoshop, Illustrator, etc.
- ☑ Macromedia Flash with ActionScript
- ☑ Macromedia Fireworks
- ☑ Macromedia Dreamweaver
- ☑ The ability to use CSS
- ☑ HTML, DHTML
- ☑ ASP
- ☑ PHP
- ☑ JavaScript
- ☑ AJAX (an added advantage)